TEXORA · LECTURE SHEET · COURSE GUIDE

Comprehensive Viva: What It Covers and How to Prepare

TE-4208 is the degree's closing oral examination: the syllabus book defines it in one line — the whole of the four years' courses, with no specific class hours. This guide states the requirement exactly, then gives clearly-labelled guidance on preparing across the whole degree.

TE-4208 · COMPREHENSIVE VIVA · GUIDE · LEVEL 4 TERM 2

1. What the syllabus requires

ITEM	AS PRINTED FOR TE-4208 COMPREHENSIVE VIVA
Scope	The viva covers **all courses studied across the four-year degree**
Class hours	**Not applicable** — the book prints no specific class hours for this course
Credit	2.0

• **What this means:** there is no topic list to revise *from* — the syllabus is the degree itself. The board may open on your specialization (your freshest material: the 4201–4203 courses, your TE-4207 project) and walk outward to any course of any term: fundamentals from Level 1, the manufacturing core of Levels 2–3, testing, quality, and the general science and engineering subjects. Everything in Sections 2–4 below is preparation guidance, not syllabus text.

2. Guidance — organising a four-year revision

(Practical guidance, not syllabus text.) A comprehensive viva rewards breadth held together by structure. A workable revision order:

1. **Your specialization, deepest first.** The seven track courses (3207, 4101, 4102, 4103, 4201, 4202, 4203) plus your project: expect to be taken furthest here, to mechanisms, calculations and machines.
2. **The manufacturing spine.** The main line of the degree in process order: fibres → yarn manufacturing → fabric manufacturing → wet processing → apparel manufacturing — with the testing and quality courses that examine each stage. Be able to walk a bale of cotton to a finished garment, naming machinery, parameters and faults at every step.

3. **The quantitative core.** The calculations any examiner can set on a whiteboard: counts and conversions, production and efficiency, moisture and add-on, costing elements, basic statistics of testing. Keep the formula families, not just the formulas.
4. **The foundation subjects.** Level 1–2 mathematics, physics, chemistry, mechanics and electrical basics at the level of "what is it for in textile engineering" — the board tests whether the foundations still stand under the degree built on them.

3. Guidance — how viva answers are built

- **Define, then explain, then give the textile example.** A definition opens the answer; the mechanism earns the marks; the mill example proves it is understood rather than memorised.
- **Follow the thread.** Viva questions chain: an answer about scouring invites one on bleaching, then on dyeing the same fabric. Answer the question asked, completely, and stop — let the board drive the chain.
- **Say what you know about what you don't know.** If a question is outside your preparation, state the neighbouring ground you do know ("I have not studied that process in depth; the related principle is…"). Boards distinguish an honest boundary from a bluff immediately.
- **Numbers carry authority.** Where a typical value exists — a temperature, a count range, an efficiency, a standard atmosphere for testing — give it. Vague answers read as vague knowledge.
- **Use your Texora sheets as the revision spine.** Every course of the degree has topic sheets with key points and glossaries; the viva pass over a course is: read the key points, speak each aloud as a 30-second answer, and note the ones that stall. Stalled points get the full sheet.

4. Guidance — the final fortnight

- Run two or three **mock vivas** with a classmate: 15 minutes, mixed terms, no notes; swap roles. The examiner's chair teaches as much as the candidate's.
- Revisit your **TE-4207 project** until you can present it in three minutes and defend its method for ten.
- Prepare a one-line identity for every course of the degree — its subject in a single sentence. If any course has no sentence, it has no revision yet.
- The day before: light review of key points only, normal sleep. A viva examines four years; it is not winnable in one night, and it is losable in one.

> **THE BOARD'S REAL QUESTION**
>
> Beneath every topic question sits one assessment: *is this graduate an engineer of the whole process, or a holder of separate course credits?* Answers that connect — fibre property to yarn

> behaviour to fabric fault to test result to cost — are what “comprehensive” means. Revise for connections, not for lists.

Glossary

Comprehensive viva — an oral examination spanning all courses of the degree. **Viva voce** — oral examination by spoken questions and answers. **Board** — the panel of examiners conducting the viva. **Specialization** — the student's final-year track (YM, FM, WP or AM), the expected centre of depth in the viva.

Key points

• Book's requirement: the viva covers all courses of the four-year degree; no specific class hours are printed; 2.0 credits.
• Prepare in rings: specialization deepest, then the manufacturing spine, the quantitative core, and the foundation subjects.
• Answer in the pattern define → explain → textile example; give typical numbers; mark honest boundaries rather than bluffing.
• Use the Texora key-points sections as the revision spine and finish with mock vivas and the project defence rehearsed.

5. Practice (preparation checklist)

1. Write the one-sentence identity of any five courses from different terms of the degree, from memory. Check each against its Texora course page.
2. Take one product — a dyed knitted T-shirt — and list, in order, the courses of the degree that touch its manufacture, with one viva question from each.
3. Speak a 30-second answer aloud: “What does your specialization add to the general degree?” Time it; repeat until it fits without rushing.

Answer key

1. Any accurate set serves; the exercise's point is diagnostic — a course you cannot summarise in one true sentence is a course to revise first. (Example pattern: TE-3105 Wet Processing-II — “the dyeing and printing of textile materials, their mechanisms, machinery and quality control.”)
2. A defensible chain: fibre science (raw material), yarn manufacturing (the yarn), knitting (the fabric), wet processing (preparation, dyeing, finishing), apparel manufacturing (cutting and sewing), testing/quality courses (every stage's control), textile calculations/costing (the numbers), and the

foundation chemistry behind the wet processes. One question per course, answered aloud, is a complete mock-viva round.

3. A strong answer names the track, its process territory, one deep capability (a machine family, a calculation set, a quality system), and where it sits in the full chain from fibre to garment — inside 30 seconds, without filler.
